



Use the classic view for a familiar environment...



...or stick to Vista's simplified view

Vista's Control Panel also tracks recent configuration tasks users have undertaken, keeping a list of the last three at the lower left corner of the Control Panel.

Like under XP, you can also launch specific elements of the Control Panel from a command line. The command line can either be a command window, or the Search box in the Start Menu. Refer to the table below to see a list of some of commands.

10.5 Windows Update

Back when Windows Update was introduced with Windows XP SP2, it was a Web service—you needed to start a Web browser in order to actually use the system update feature. With Vista, Update has transitioned to a system service, that is, it no longer runs on a Web page, but it part of the OS itself. This transition was largely done to address the concern that a Web service would not be secure enough to handle system updates. Under Vista, the Update feature provides updates for the operating system and related components, such as definition updates for Windows Defender, spam filter updates for Windows Mail, the usual system updates, and even updates to other Microsoft products such as the Office suite. The feature also allows third parties to register themselves under the service, such that updates to third-party software might also be pushed through the Windows Update feature.